

Syllabus

SPHU-4560-02, 3 credits Capstone Seminar: Ethics and Leadership in Public Health Spring 2023

Wednesdays, 12:00–12:50 p.m.
B16, Howard-Tilton Memorial Library

Instructor: Simone J. Skeen, MA

Email: sskeen@tulane.edu

Office Hours: Wednesdays, 12:50–1:50 p.m. Howard Tilton Library, or virtually by appointment

I am typically available by email during the workday, but will not respond to emails sent after 9:00 p.m. until the morning following.

Course Aims

This seminar is designed for public health students approaching the end of their degree program. The course fulfills the Public Health capstone requirement. The seminar involves open discussion, reflection, and perspective-taking on emerging, historical, and contentious topics related to the practice of public health; job opportunities in public health; and professional development.

Course Goals

The class sessions will facilitate individual growth and career development through thought-provoking scholarly readings, primary sources, and multimedia, intended to spur dialogue among students and integrate public health pedagogy with the everyday experiences of public health professionals – and the communities we serve.

Course Objectives

- Encourage open dialogue, structured problem-solving, and peer-to-peer social support as students undertake their PSIP
- Provide a supportive environment to discuss career goals, professional development, and express personal and professional ambitions
- Learn to synthesize the skills and experiences obtained during students' degree programs (and lives) into a compelling professional narrative
- Learn to integrate multilevel, evidence-based, and theoretically guided perspectives on contemporary health issues with the practical wisdom of real-world, everyday, public health practice

Required Student Resources

Readings and multimedia: All required scholarly articles, chapters, and multimedia are available via Canvas. There is no textbook for this course. Students are responsible for keeping up with the required readings posted to Canvas.

Printing: Assignments will be submitted on Canvas in a Microsoft Word .docx or Adobe PDF format. No printing will be required, though you are welcome to bring printouts to support class discussion.

Laptops and tablets: Please bring your laptop or tablet to class. If doing so presents a challenge to you, please email me.

Evaluation and Grading

Participation (20%): A seminar relies on active, engaged, dialogue, inclusive of all participants, in order to be a success. It is imperative that you:

- Engage with the assigned readings and multimedia in a timely manner, and arrive ready to contribute to the reflection prompts provided below
- Interact in a respectful, professional, manner with your peers
- Attend class in person, contributing meaningfully and substantively to discussions around PSIP experiences, and the relevant contemporary public health issues we will cover.

Reflection Papers (40%): Students are expected to submit 4 reflection essays over the course of the semester.

- Reflection Paper 1: The Developmental Stages of an Internship
- Reflection Paper 2: Epistemic In/Justice
- Reflection Paper 3: Structural Determinants (select an issue)
- Reflection Paper 4: Community Determinants (select an issue)

Reflection essays are meant to provide a venue in which you can integrate the issues we discuss, your PSIP experience, and your own public health knowledge. Students' thoughts need not be "final" – the strongest essays will grapple with tension and uncertainty, while maintaining a scholarly polish.

≥3 p., 11-pt. double-spaced Arial or Times New Roman.

Mock Cover Letter (10%): While covering career development, students will write a mock cover letter, and peer review each other's cover letters in pairs. The purpose of this assignment is to synthesize your skills, experiences, and professional ambitions into a clear, compelling narrative – something you will be called upon to accomplish innumerable times in your career.

1 p., 11-pt. *single-spaced* Arial or Times New Roman.

Site-in-Context Presentation (10%): Students will familiarize themselves with the scientific literature on the health issue their PSIP site seeks to address, and deliver a brief presentation describing, succinctly, the precise ways in which their hosting organization promotes community health.

5–7-min., PowerPoint or Google Slides.

Site-in-Context Analysis (20%): Students will adapt their presentation into a brief report, synthesizing foundational public health skillsets and concepts to describe the precise role your PSIP organization plays in New Orleans. The strongest analyses will seamlessly align population-level (epidemiological and policy) perspectives with the community- and individual-level changes that your hosting organization brings into the lives of its clients.

3–5 pp., 11-pt. double-spaced Arial or Times New Roman.

Note that the above grades will account for 70% of your SPHU 4560 final grade; your supervisor's evaluation will account for another 30%.

Detailed instructions for each assignment will be provided in Canvas.

Grading schema

100–94% A	76–73% C
93–90% A-	72–70% C-
89–87% B+	69–67% D+
86–83% B	66–63% D
82–80% B-	62–60% D-
79–77% C+	59–0% F

Note: Students concerned about their grades are encouraged to contact me at any time during the semester, so that we can discuss resources and commit to a plan for improvement. Once assignment grades are

submitted, grades will not be altered, outside of extreme (and rare) extenuating circumstances. Once semester grades are submitted, no alterations whatsoever will be considered.

Code of Academic Conduct

The Code of Academic Conduct applies to all undergraduate students, full-time and part-time, in Tulane University. Tulane University expects and requires behavior compatible with its high standards of scholarship. By accepting admission to the university, a student accepts its regulations (i.e., Code of Academic Conduct and Code of Student Conduct) and acknowledges the right of the university to take disciplinary action, including suspension or expulsion, for conduct judged unsatisfactory or disruptive.

The use of ChatGPT or any generative large language model, at any stage of your writing, constitutes plagiarism. Any instance of academic dishonesty will be reported to the academic judiciary. Students are required to adhere to the University Honor Code, available online at <https://college.tulane.edu/academic-honesty>.

Late Assignments

Late assignments will lose 5% of their grade for every *unexcused* 24 hours of lateness past their submission deadline. If it seems likely that you will miss a deadline, for any reason, please contact me and we will work out a plan.

Equity, Diversity, and Inclusion Statement (EDI)

Equity, diversity, and inclusion (EDI) are important Tulane values that are key drivers of academic excellence in our learning environments. In our drive for academic excellence, we seek to ensure that students, faculty, and staff across diverse social identities, cultural backgrounds, and lived experiences can thrive – especially those from underrepresented and underserved communities (e.g., race/ethnicity, gender identity and expression, sexual orientation, disability, social class, international, veterans, religious minorities, age, and any other classification protected by applicable law – see Tulane's Nondiscrimination Policy). In order to build a supportive culture and climate for every member of our community, we recognize that we each of have unique EDI strengths to share with others and that we also have areas for EDI growth, learning, and change. This EDI commitment and cultural humility helps us collectively build a university community and culture where everyone experiences belonging.

Attendance Statement

Combined with participation, attendance is worth 20% of your grade. All students are required to attend class regularly. You are expected to attend class in person unless you are ill or experiencing exceptional circumstances. For an excused absence, you must contact me *as early as possible* (and as is reasonable). *Unexcused* absences (which include absences that would typically be excused if you do not communicate with me in a reasonable amount of time) will result in a 1% deduction from your grade for each absence.

Class session recordings: Class will *not* be recorded, except in extreme extenuating circumstances (such as an evacuation). Students should feel safe to express their uncertainties, apprehensions, and individual perspectives, without their words being recorded.

ADA/Accessibility Statement

Tulane University strives to make all learning experiences as accessible as possible. If you anticipate or experience academic barriers based on your disability, please let me know immediately so that we can privately discuss options. I will never ask for medical documentation from you to support potential accommodation needs. Instead, to establish reasonable accommodations, I may request that you register with the Goldman Center for Student Accessibility. After registration, make arrangements with me as soon as possible to discuss your accommodations so that they may be implemented in a timely fashion.

Goldman Center contact information: goldman@tulane.edu; (504) 862-8433; accessibility.tulane.edu.

Course Schedule and Readings

All assignments are to be uploaded to Canvas by 12:00 p.m. – noon – on their due-dates.

Week 1: Background and Introductions	
Due by Wednesday, Jan 18, 12:00 pm	Review the CPS <i>Public Service Internships 2022-2023 Student Handbook</i> . [Canvas]
Reflection prompts	Be prepared to introduce yourself, describe your internship placement and duties, and share your own PH ambitions and short-term career goals
Week 2: The Internship Trajectory	
Due by Wednesday, Jan 25, 12:00 pm	Register for a CPS “Engaging Communities” workshop: http://engagingcommunities.eventbrite.com (recommended) Reflection Paper 1
Readings, media	- Green A. What your internship manager wishes you knew. <i>U.S. News & World Report</i>. Published April 28, 2014. https://money.usnews.com/money/blogs/outside-voices-careers/2014/04/28/what-your-internship-manager-wishes-you-knew - Sweitzer HF, King MA. Chapter 3: Framing the experience: The developmental stages of an internship. In: Sweitzer HF, King MA, eds. <i>The Successful Internship: Personal, Professional and Civic Development</i>. Cengage Learning; 2009:49-59. [Canvas]* *Read only Chapter 3, which begins on p. 49.
Reflection prompts	For Reflection Paper 1: - When, in your own life, have you confronted <u>disillusionment</u> and <u>crises of growth</u>? - How were you able to surmount these challenges? - How can you call on these experiences to prepare you for your internship? In formulating your ideas, use the concepts and terminology introduced by Sweitzer and King (see Table 3.1) to clarify your ideas.
Week 3: Career Development I	
Internship Milestone: target start date (Feb 1)	
Due by Wednesday, Feb 1, 12:00 pm	n/a
Readings, media	- Review section I. “Confidentiality” of the <i>PSIP Student Handbook</i> [Canvas] - American Public Health Association (APHA). Advice for Undergrads. https://www.apha.org/professional-development/public-health-careermart/careers-in-public-health-newsletter/job-searching-salaries-and-more/advice-for-undergrads - Association of Schools & Programs of Public Health (ASPPH). Students & Alumni: Profiles in Public Health. https://aspvh.org/students-alumni/profiles/ - Nguyen T. Gen Z does not dream of labor. Vox. Updated April 2, 2022. https://www.vox.com/the-highlight/22977663/gen-z-antiwork-capitalism

Reflection prompts	<i>For class discussion:</i> • What are your first impressions of your internship site? Your supervisor? • How might your past experiences and <u>social location</u> influence these impressions? • What surprised you? Be prepared to describe your internship site's mission and scope of practice, share your first-week experiences, and to support each other through any first-week challenges.
Week 4: Career Development II	
Due by Wednesday, Feb 8, 12:00 pm	Schedule a career advising appointment with SPHTM Career Services: https://sph.tulane.edu/career-students (recommended) Mock Cover Letter
Readings, media	• Tulane University SPHTM. Career Services for Students. https://sph.tulane.edu/career-students • Tulane University Newcomb-Tulane College Career Services. Student Career Guides. https://hiretulane.tulane.edu/resources/student-career-guides
Reflection prompts	<i>For class discussion:</i> • What do you like about writing cover letters? What do you dislike? Why? • What are the <u>stories</u> we want to tell to prospective employers? Be prepared to offer incisive, supportive critiques of your peers' cover letters during the class period.
Week 5: Epistemic Violence, Epistemic Justice	
Due by Wednesday, Feb 15, 12:00 pm	n/a
Readings, media	• Dotson K. Tracking epistemic violence, tracking practices of silencing. <i>Hypatia</i>. 2011;26:236-257. doi: 10.1111/j.1527-2001.2011.01177.x [Canvas]* • Minalga B, Chung C, Davids JD, et al. Research on transgender people must benefit transgender people. <i>Lancet</i>. 2022;399:P628. doi: 10.1016/S0140-6736(21)02806-3 [Canvas] • Lipson M. Meet the “lunatics” fighting for psychiatry abolition at Mad Pride. <i>The Face</i>. Published July 19, 2022. https://theface.com/society/fighting-for-psychiatry-abolition-mad-pride-2022 *This is a philosophical Black Feminist text, and one of the most important you will read in this class. It is recommended that you set aside extra time to absorb it.
Reflection prompts	<i>For class discussion:</i>

	• In addition to Dotson's examples, what are some instances of <u>testimonial quieting</u> and <u>testimonial smothering</u> that you've encountered? • How can our <u>social position</u> prompt "<u>unknowing</u>"? • How do these dynamics play out within public health practice? Among the concepts introduced by Dotson, focus on one that you find particularly resonant, and be prepared to discuss why and how. Think, in particular, of how they may relate to ethics and leadership.
Week 6: Structural I: Policy and Profit	
Readings, media	Select any three: • Food and Drug Administration, Department of Health and Human Services. <i>Proposed Rule: Tobacco Product Standard for Menthol in Cigarettes</i>. [Docket No. FDA–2021–N–1349]; 21 CFR Part 1162. [Canvas]* • Holloway K. The ridiculously racist history of menthol cigarettes. <i>The Daily Beast</i>. Published May 10, 2021. https://www.thedailybeast.com/the-ridiculously-racist-history-of-menthol-cigarettes • American Civil Liberties Union. <i>Coalition Letter of Concern to HHS on Menthol Cigarette Ban</i>. Published April 26, 2021. https://www.aclu.org/letter/coalition-letter-concern-hhs-menthol-cigarette-ban • Erickson B. Deinstitutionalization through optimism: the Community Mental Health Act of 1963. <i>Am J Psychiatry</i>. 2021;16:6-7. doi: 10.1176/appi.ajp-rj.2021.160404 [Canvas] • <i>Bedlam</i> [documentary film: 85 min]. https://bedlamfilm.com/about† • Blau M. Marketing psychiatric drugs to jailers and judges. <i>The Atlantic</i>. Published December 31, 2019. https://www.theatlantic.com/politics/archive/2019/12/pharmaceutical-companies-are-marketing-drugs-jailers/604264/ *Read only the Executive Summary, which begins on p. 26455. †<i>Bedlam</i> is, overarchingly, a story of hope and resistance. But it is unflinching in portraying the failures of our psychiatric system. The film includes brief images of self-harm, and mentions of suicide and police violence.
Reflection prompts	• In contemporary psychiatry, in the controversies surrounding menthol cigarettes, how are <u>policy</u> and <u>profit</u> intertwined? • How do these structural forces affect everyday lives? Over the lifecourse? • What possible solutions do you see – at the community level? The policy level?
Due by Sunday, Feb 26, 11:59 pm	Reflection Paper 2: Epistemic In/Justice in Public Health* *Unlike my usual noon Wednesday deadlines, this paper is due before midnight Friday. <i>Laissez les bons temps rouler</i>.
Week 7: Structural II: Bureaucracy	

Due by Wednesday, Mar 1, 12:00 pm	n/a
Readings, media	- Herd P, Moynihan D. How administrative burdens can harm health. <i>Health Affairs Policy Brief</i>. Published October 2, 2020. https://www.healthaffairs.org/doi/10.1377/hpb20200904.405159/ - U.S. Citizenship and Immigration Services, Department of Homeland Security. <i>I-589, Application for Asylum and for Withholding of Removal</i>. OMB No. 1615-0067. [Canvas] - Graeber D. Dead zones of the imagination: on violence, bureaucracy, and interpretive labor. <i>HAU: J Ethnogr</i>. 2012;2: 105-128. doi: 10.14318/hau2.2.007 [Canvas]* *Focus your attentions on Sections III–IV, please.
Reflection prompts	- In your PSIP, where do you see examples of <u>learning costs</u>, <u>compliance costs</u>, <u>psychological costs</u>? - What about <u>interpretive labor</u>? - How does Graeber adapt the generally accepted understanding of <u>structural violence</u>? What are your own thoughts?
Week 8: Community I: Engagement	
Due by Sunday, Mar 12, 11:59 pm	Reflection Paper 3: Structural
Readings, media	Select any two: - Michener L, Aguilar-Gaxiola S, Alberti PM, et al. Engaging with communities — lessons (re)learned from COVID-19. <i>Prev Chronic Dis</i>. 2020;17:200250. doi: 10.5888/pcd17.200250. [Canvas] - Alonso J. Johns Hopkins University’s move to create a police force raises concerns. <i>Inside Higher Ed</i>. Published September 22, 2022. https://www.insidehighered.com/news/2022/09/22/johns-hopkins-moves-forward-private-police-force - Sandwick T, Fine M, Greene AC, et al. Promise and provocation: humble reflections on critical participatory action research for social policy. <i>Urban Educ</i>. 2018;53:473-502. doi: 10.1177/0042085918763513 [Canvas]
Reflection prompts	- Michener et al. provide a rich overview of community engagement successes during the early U.S. pandemic. Which do you find most resonant? Most encouraging? - What do Sandwick et al. mean by “<u>Statelessness scrambles the frequencies of legitimacy</u>?”
Internship Milestone: 30 (of 60) hours completed	
Week 9: Community II: Organizing, Direct Action	
Due	n/a
Readings, media	Select any three:

	- Bassett MT. Beyond berets: the Black Panthers as health activists. <i>Am J Public Health</i>. 2016;106:1741-1742. doi: 10.2105/AJPH.2016.303412 [Canvas] - Francis Snyder E; featuring the Young Lords. <i>The Hospital Occupation That Changed Public Health Care</i> [documentary film: 39 min]. https://www.nytimes.com/2021/10/12/opinion/young-lords-nyc-activism-takeover.html <i>How to Survive a Plague</i> [documentary film: 110 min]. https://surviveaplague.com/see-the-doc - Braine N. Autonomous health movements: criminalization, de-medicalization, and community-based direct action. <i>Health Hum Rights</i>. 2020;22:85-97. PMID: 33390699 [Canvas]
Reflection prompts	- What do you notice in the ways that the Black Panthers and/or Young Lords planned their own direct services? - How do they contrast with the movements and actions described by Braine? - Among the lasting victories of ACT UP was a truly fundamental shift in the conduct of clinical trials – how, and why, was this among their demands?
Week 10: Interpersonal I: Mutual Aid, DIY	
Due by Sunday, Mar 26, 11:59 pm	Reflection Paper 4: Community
Readings, media	Select any two: - Finding the thread that binds us: three mutual aid networks in New York City. <i>Crimethinc</i>. Published June 26, 2020. https://crimethinc.com/2020/06/26/finding-the-thread-that-binds-us-three-mutual-aid-networks-in-new-york-city - Gill-Peterson J. Doctors who? Radical lessons from the history of DIY transition. <i>The Baffler</i>. Published October, 2022. https://thebaffler.com/salvos/doctors-who-gill-peterson - Taladrid S. The post-Roe abortion underground. <i>The New Yorker</i>. Published October 10, 2022. [Canvas]
Reflection prompts	- Mutual aid networks vehemently reject traditional notions of “charity” – why? - Clear similarities will be evident between the DIY practices described by Gill-Peterson and by Taladrid – why? - Does your own PSIP site maintain an official stance on DIY community care? What about unofficially (or implicitly)?
Week 11: Interpersonal II: PH Career Resilience, Joy in Work	
Due by Wednesday, Mar 29, 12:00 pm	n/a
Readings, media	Preston PJ. We must practice what we preach: a framework to promote well-being and sustainable performance in the public health workforce in the United States. <i>J Public Health Policy</i>. 2022;43:140-148. doi: 10.1057/s41271-021-00335-5

	- Smith DD. Compassion fatigue is real and it may be weighing you down. <i>Harvard Business Review</i>. Published March 30, 2022. [Canvas] - National Association of County & City Health Officials (NACCHO). Public Health Workforce Resilience Resource Library. https://www.naccho.org/programs/our-covid-19-response/public-health-resilience* - NACCHO. <i>Joy in Work Toolkit</i>. Published July 2022. https://www.naccho.org/uploads/downloadable-resources/JOY-IN-WORK-TOOLKIT-VFINAL-7-20-22.pdf* *Please familiarize yourself with these resources for the day's discussion, but they are meant primarily for future reference.
Reflection prompts	- When have you confronted <u>compassion fatigue</u> in your own life? In your PSIP? - How does attaching a name to that feeling help, or hinder, your <u>career resilience</u>? - Where, when, and how do you find <u>joy in work</u>?
Week 12: Spring Break: NO CLASS	
Week 13: Class Presentations I	
Due by Wednesday, Apr 12, 12:00 pm	Site-in-Context Presentations
Reflection prompts	n/a
Week 14: Class Presentations II	
Due by Wednesday, Apr 19, 12:00 pm	Site-in-Context Presentations (cont.)
Reflection prompts	n/a
Week 15: Closing	
Due by Wednesday, Apr 26, 12:00 pm	Site-in-Context Analysis
Reflection prompts	
Internship Milestone: target end date (May 1)	

Tutoring

You can schedule a 1:1 tutoring appointment with a peer tutor at <https://web.penjiapp.com/schools/tulane>. Select the ALTC Community.

Writing Coaching: You can schedule an in-person or virtual writing consultation with one of our Writing Coaches at <https://web.penjiapp.com/schools/tulane>. Select the Writing Center Community.

To get the most out of your writing appointment:

- Bring all prompts, drafts, notes and relevant research/support materials with you.
- When you receive your appointment conformation email, reply and attach a copy of your paper for the Writing Coach to preview prior to your session.
- Have specific questions or areas that you want to work on.
- We recommend that students schedule at least 2 sessions for an average paper and 3 for a major assignment. 1 during the brainstorming and research collection stage, the 2nd after the first rough draft has been completed, and the 3rd prior to submitting the final draft.
- Good writing requires time and we strongly discourage last minute appointments. If your paper is due at noon and you show up at 10:00 with a rough draft, there isn't much we can do but commiserate with you on the poor grade you are going to receive.

Writing resources for academic writing, presentations, and ESL tools can be found on our website here: <https://success.tulane.edu/altc/academic-writing-center>

If you need help with research, citations, writing software, or citation apps, the Howard-Tilton Memorial Library has a Research Help Desk and Subject Area Librarians to help you. They also offer workshops and presentations on a variety of topics and tools that support research and writing. You can access their resources and contact a Research Librarian here: <https://library.tulane.edu/services>

Title IX

Tulane University recognizes the inherent dignity of all individuals and promotes respect for all people. As such, Tulane is committed to providing an environment free of all forms of discrimination including sexual and gender-based discrimination, harassment, and violence like sexual assault, intimate partner violence, and stalking. If you (or someone you know) has experienced or is experiencing these types of behaviors, know that you are not alone. Resources and support are available: you can learn more at allin.tulane.edu. Any and all of your communications on these matters will be treated as either “Confidential” or “Private” as explained in the chart below. Please know that if you choose to confide in me I am required by the university to share your disclosure in a Care Connection to the Office of Case Management and Victim Support Services to be sure you are connected with all the support the university can offer. The Office of University Sexual Misconduct Response and Title IX Administration is also notified of these disclosures. You choose whether or not you want to meet with these offices. You can also make a disclosure yourself, including an anonymous report, through the form at tulane.edu/concerns.

Confidential	Private
<i>Except in extreme circumstances, involving imminent danger to one’s self or others, nothing will be shared without your explicit permission.</i> ▪ Counseling & Psychological Services (CAPS) (504) 314-2277 ▪ The Line (24/7) (504) 264-6074 ▪ Student Health Center (504) 865-5255 ▪ Sexual Aggression Peer Hotline and Education (SAPHE) (504) 654-9543	<i>Conversations are kept as confidential as possible, but information is shared with key staff members so the University can offer resources and accommodations and take action if necessary for safety reasons.</i> ▪ Case Management & Victim Support Services (504) 314-2160 or srss@tulane.edu ▪ Tulane University Police (TUPD) Uptown - (504) 865-5911 Downtown – (504) 988-5531 ▪ Office of University Sexual Misconduct Response and Title IX Administration (504) 865-5611 or titleix@tulane.edu ▪ Student Affairs Professional On-Call (24/7) (504) 920-9900

Emergency Preparedness & Response

EMERGENCY NOTIFICATIONS: TU ALERT	SEVERE WEATHER
In the event of a campus emergency, Tulane University will notify students, faculty, and staff by email, text, and/or phone call. You were automatically enrolled in this system when you enrolled at the university. Check your contact information annually in Gibson Online to confirm its accuracy.	▪ Follow all TU Alerts and outdoor warning sirens ▪ Seek shelter indoors until the severe weather threat has passed and an all-clear message is given ▪ Do not use elevators ▪ Do not attempt to travel outside if weather is severe Monitor the Tulane Emergency website (tulane.edu/emergency/) for university-wide closures during a severe weather event
ACTIVE SHOOTER / VIOLENT ATTACKER	EVERBRIDGE APP

▪ <u>RUN</u> – run away from or avoid the affected area, if possible ▪ <u>HIDE</u> – go into the nearest room that can be locked, turn out the lights, and remain hidden until all-clear message is given through TU ALERT ▪ <u>FIGHT</u> – do not attempt this option, except as a last resort ▪ For more information or to schedule a training, visit emergencyprep.tulane.edu	▪ Download the Everbridge app from the App Store or Google Play store ▪ The Report feature allows you to silently and discreetly communicate with TUPD dispatchers ▪ The SOS button allows you to notify TUPD if you need help ▪ The Safe Corridor button serves as a virtual escort and allows you to send check-in notifications to TUPD
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From: Tulane Office of Emergency Preparedness and Response